Information for Undergraduate First-Year Students (Year 1)
2025/26 Academic Year

General information

Academic calendar 2025/26

Welcome Week
Monday 22 September – Friday 26 September 2025

Semester 1

Teaching: Monday 29 September – Friday 31 October 2025

Reading Week (no teaching): Monday 3 November – Friday 7 November 2025

Teaching: Monday 10 November – Friday 12 December 2025

Teaching/Revision: Monday 15 December – Friday 19 December 2025

Examination Period: Friday 9 January – Thursday 15 January 2026

Semester 2

Teaching: Friday 16 January – Friday 20 February 2026

Reading Week (no teaching): Monday 23 February – Friday 27 February 2026

Teaching: Monday 2 March – Thursday 2 April 2026

Teaching/Revision: Monday 27 April – Friday 1 May 2026

Examination Period: Tuesday 5 May – Friday 5 June 2026

Please note that you may also need to be available to take resit (or replacements for deferred exams) in August.

August Examination Period: Monday 10 August – Friday 21 August 2026

Students are expected to complete their resit or deferred assessments in the August reassessment period. All exams take place in person, and students who need to complete an exam should ensure they are able to be present in London during the August period to sit their assessments.

Teaching

We know how much our students value the on-campus experience here at King's and we encourage you to make the most of teaching, learning, networking, and socialising on our campuses.

Flipped Classroom
Most of our modules use the 'flipped classroom' approach. In the flipped classroom approach, we deliver module content through videos and other materials via KEATS. This makes space in the in-person sessions for you to benefit maximally from the world-class experts in the Department – through discussions, exercises, and Q&A sessions. Flipped classroom teaching has been proven in the education-research literature to significantly improve student learning and outcomes. We are looking forward to offering great opportunities for intensive interaction with your teachers and peers.

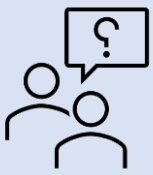
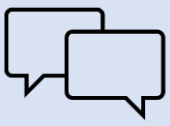
Timetable
Your timetable is found via KCL MyTimetable.

- Video content and materials on KEATS will not be scheduled as teaching on your timetable. You are expected to undertake this learning independently in your own time, planning when you complete this in accordance with when your live, timetabled teaching takes place.
- **Large Group Tutorials:** These will take place on campus which will allow you to engage with the Module Leader.
- **Small Group Tutorials:** These will take place on campus and led by Teaching Assistants and an opportunity for peer-to-peer learning in smaller groups.
- **Practicals:** these will take place on campus and led by Teaching Assistants and an opportunity for peer-to-peer learning.

Independent study
Completing your degree requires a large amount of independent learning. This will involve reading the materials on KEATS and completing coursework (in some modules but not all) that is designed to enhance your learning and provide formal assessment.

Modules	
Taking modules outside the department and/or outside your programme	During Year 1, you cannot take modules from outside the Department or your programme. **<u>Language modules</u>** You can take a language course as "not for credit" (this means that it will not count towards your degree). Please visit the King's Language Centre's website for more information. In Year 1, you cannot take a language module "for credit" as part of your degree so this cannot go on your student record.
Requesting to change your modules/choosing your modules	You will be automatically enrolled onto your modules in Year 1, and you cannot request to change them as they are all compulsory. More information on your modules can be found on the programme page.
Teaching and Specialist Equipment	
Recorded Content	This will vary from module to module but could include: • Recorded material, split into 5-to-15-minute videos. • Reading of articles, book chapters, academic journals, etc. • Self-assessment activities.
Large Group Tutorials	These sessions will be delivered on campus by the Module Leader(s).
Small Group Tutorials	These will be delivered on campus by Teaching Assistants (TA's). Small Group Tutorials will vary from module to module. Some modules may only have small-group tutorials every other week whilst others may have them every week. Your timetable will show how each module is structured.
Labs	There will be some teaching timetabled in the labs for students on-campus. While installing most of the software directly on your device will be possible, we will recommend configuring a Linux based virtual machine for consistency with the NMES lab-based environment. Please see the Computer Lab Rules for what is expected of you in these spaces.
Specialist equipment/specialist software	Most teaching exercises will run on a modestly spec'd laptop or desktop computer. For minimum requirements, see the NMES Computing Services Wiki. In case your computer does not meet these requirements, options will be available to ensure you are provided with the necessary computing environment. You can use the NMES Computing Services Wiki for further information. Some modules and projects may also require more computational resources, again, in these cases a suitable hosted computing environment will be made available.
Assessment and Feedback	

Assessment	Your modules will be assessed through a combination of methods including coursework, examinations, and presentations. An overview of the assessment structure for each of your modules, can be found here. Further information will also be available on the KEATS page for each module. Your Semester 1 exam period will take place between Friday 9 January – Thursday 15 January 2026. Exam information including your exam timetable will be made available towards the end of Semester 1.
Assessment results	**Coursework** For Summative Coursework (that counts towards module marks), you should receive feedback within four weeks of submission. **Exam marks** Exam marks will be released at the same time as module marks (please see below for more information) **Module marks:** **Semester 1:** Provisional results will be released in March 2026. **Semester 2:** Results will be released in July 2026 **August reassessment**: Results will be released September 2026 ahead of the start of the 2026/27 academic year. **Overall mark for the year** You will receive your overall marks for the year in July 2026 (at the same time as your Semester 2 results), or September 2026, if you have August assessments. You will receive an email from Taught Student Records to confirm once your final results are available to view on Student Records.
Feedback	You will be given feedback via different methods depending on your module and the ways that you have been assessed/interact with your fellow students, module lecturers and teaching assistants. Different methods of feedback which you might receive include: • Individual feedback • General feedback on the performance of the cohort for submitted work or an exam • Automated individual feedback on quizzes and programming tasks • Feedback from your peers • Self-evaluation where you will comment on your contribution/performance • Asking questions in on campus sessions • Asking questions in discussion forums • Revision sessions
Timetables and Study Space	
Timetables	The standard teaching day will be from 9am – 6pm. There may be occurrences when teaching is scheduled outside of this. You will see details when you have access to your personal timetable. Find your timetable via KCL MyTimetable.
Using lab and study spaces within the Department of Informatics	Study spaces will be available to students in the library. Departmental computer labs are open to students during term-time and vacations (except Bank Holidays, and College closure days such as the Christmas period). When using the Department's computer labs or study spaces, there are rules that you need to abide by. Below are the codes of conduct for Computer Labs and Shared Study Space in Bush House. Informatics Lab Space Rules Informatics Study Space Rules
Support	

 Your Personal Tutor	You will be assigned a Personal Tutor and will receive an email to confirm who your tutor is and how to contact them. You will be part of a tutor group, with other students in their first year (likely on the same programme) and you will book to meet with your Personal Tutor throughout the academic year. If you would like to talk to your Personal Tutor outside of these group meetings, please contact them to make an appointment.
 Academic office hours	All academic staff in the Department have advertised academic office hours during term-time in which you can see them outside lectures. Office hours may take the form of fixed slots each week when lecturers are available in their offices or may be appointments arranged by email. Many staff will also make appointments with students outside these times if you urgently need to see them.
 Questions regarding your programme, modules etc.	**General queries** You will be able to ask general questions about your particular module(s) on the online Forums feature on KEATS module pages. You will also be able to see what questions other students are asking and contribute to the answers if you wish. **Queries about your specific circumstances** Please contact your Programmes Officers: Daniel Ashmore, Emma-Louise McAuley and Harriet Veldtrup **Email**: informatics-ug@kcl.ac.uk **Department Office**: The Department office [(N)6.11, Bush House] will be open during the following hours: • **Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, and Friday:** 10am – 4pm. • **Wednesday:** 10am – 2pm. There will be a Programme Officer present at the Informatics Department office, and you are welcome to drop into the office during these hours. Emails will be responded to in working hours (9am – 5pm, Monday to Friday). You should not expect a response outside of these hours, at the weekend or on Bank Holidays. The team aim to respond to all emails within 3 working days, but please bear in mind that during busy periods this might take longer.
 Expected Behaviour	Staff and students are expected to behave respectfully to one another during lectures, outside of lectures and when communicating online or through email. We will not tolerate inappropriate or demeaning comments related to gender, gender identity and expression, sexual orientation, disability, physical appearance, race, religion, age, or any other personal characteristic. If you witness or experience any behaviour you are concerned about, please speak to someone about it. This could be one of your lecturers, your personal tutor, a programme administrator, the diversity & inclusion co-chairs (Alfie Abdul-Rahman & Kathleen Steinhöfel) at informatics-diversity@kcl.ac.uk, a trained harassment advisor, or any member of staff you feel comfortable talking about it to. For more information, please visit: Welcome to Equality, Diversity & Inclusion and Wellbeing at King's.
 Report + Support	Report + Support has now launched for all members of the King's community to report incidences of inappropriate or disrespectful behaviour – from micro-aggressions to bullying and harassment – that you have experienced or witnessed. These reports can be made anonymously. Please do not feel you need to tolerate any behaviour that makes you feel uncomfortable or unwelcome whilst studying and working at King's. If you have any questions about the process or would like to give feedback, please email: reportandsupport@kcl.ac.uk.
 Other useful resources	• Student Handbook 2025/26 • Health & Wellbeing • King's Careers & Employability • Student Services Online (SSO) • Student Services Frontline • Academic calendar • IT Support • King's Sport & Wellness • King's Venues • Learning & Teaching

	• Libraries & Collections • King's Language Centre • Student's Union – KCLSU's Wellbeing Hub